

A background image showing three people in a professional setting. A woman with long braids and glasses is smiling and gesturing, while two other people listen. The image has a blue tint and a yellow outline around the woman in the foreground.

Alignment of the Canadian Language Benchmarks to the Global Scale of English: Stage III Advanced

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About the GSE

Pearson developed the Global Scale of English (GSE) to provide instructors and learners with a more detailed understanding of English language proficiency. It has been designed to build learners' confidence by revealing exactly where they are on their learning journey and setting personalised goals to help them progress.

The GSE is an ecosystem that underpins the Pearson English Journey:

- **GSE Scale:** a proficiency scale from 10 to 90.
- **GSE Learning Objectives:** descriptions of what learners can do at each level of proficiency in speaking, listening, reading, and writing.
- **Courseware:** all of Pearson's English language learning courseware is developed using the GSE Learning Objectives.
- **Assessment:** institutions can develop their own assessment materials using the GSE Learning Objectives and Assessment Frameworks or choose one of Pearson's digital assessments which report on the GSE.

The GSE is the result of many years of research with more than 6,000 teachers from over 50 countries. It serves as a standard against which English language courses and assessments worldwide can be benchmarked.

The GSE has been psychometrically aligned to the Common European Framework of Reference or CEFR (see De Jong, Mayor, & Hayes, 2016). It complements and extends the CEFR by adding an extra layer of detail to the CEFR levels and providing thousands of additional learning objectives. This extra information helps learners understand where they are now and offers a step-by-step guide to where they want to go next. Using the GSE, teachers can match a student to course materials to suit their exact level and learning goals.

CEFR level	GSE Scale
Below A1	10–21
A1	22–29
A2	30–35
A2+ ('plus level')	36–42
B1	43–50
B1+ ('plus level')	51–58
B2	59–66
B2+ ('plus level')	67–75
C1	76–84
C2	85–90

Table 1: The relationship between the GSE and the CEFR

To address the specific needs of learners studying English for different purposes, GSE Learning Objectives have been developed for five different learner audiences:

- **adult:** adults studying on a general English course
- **academic:** adults studying academic English
- **professional:** adults studying English for the workplace
- **young learner:** English language learners aged 6–14
- **pre-primary:** English language learners aged 3–5

For more information:

[pearson.com/languages/why-pearson/the-global-scale-of-english](https://www.pearson.com/languages/why-pearson/the-global-scale-of-english)

About Canadian Language Benchmarks

For the purposes of this alignment, we worked with the 2012 edition of *Canadian Language Benchmarks: English as a Second Language for Adults*. The Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLB) are written as 12 benchmarks along a continuum from basic to advanced. These 12 benchmarks are then organised into three stages, each associated with a degree of complexity and demand.

This report looks at the four benchmarks in Stage III – Advanced Language Ability:

“Advanced language ability encompasses abilities required to communicate effectively, appropriately, accurately and fluently about most topics in a wide range of contexts and situations, from predictable to unfamiliar, from general to professionally complex and from specific to nuanced, in communicatively demanding contexts. Learners at this stage have a sense of purpose and audience when communicating (including distance, politeness and formality factors, appropriate register and style, suitable volume or length of communication, accuracy and coherence of discourse, vocabulary range and precision). At this stage, communicating can involve using language within high-stakes or high-risk social, academic and work-related contexts, and in situations in which features of the communication (such as diplomacy, tact, precision) can have significant consequences. In the CLB, these are referred to as demanding contexts of language use” (CLB, p10)

Stage III – Advanced Language Ability

Benchmark and Ability Level	Listening	Speaking	Reading	Writing
CLB 9: Initial CLB 10: Developing CLB 11: Adequate CLB 12: Fluent	Interpreting complex spoken communication in demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.	Creating complex spoken communication in demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.	Interpreting complex written communication in demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.	Creating complex written communication in demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.

Table 2: Stage III – Advanced Language Ability (CLB, p11)

For each language skill, there are four broad representative competency areas: Interacting with others, Instructions, Getting things done, Sharing information.

Alignment Methodology and Results

Each Canadian Language Benchmark competency statement within each competency area was aligned to one or more GSE Learning Objectives. The profile of ability, sample indicators of ability and sample tasks were also consulted during the alignment. Given that the target audience for CLBs is adult learners, GSE Learning Objectives for Adults, Professionals and Academic were used.

The results of the GSE alignment show consistency with the CEFR-CLB alignment carried out by North and Piccardo in 2018.

Stage	CLB level	GSE range	CEFR-CLB alignment (North & Piccardo)
I: Basic	1	10-19	<A1
	2	20-27	A1
	3	28-34	A1/A2
	4	35-41	A2/A2+
II: Intermediate	5	42-46	B1
	6	47-52	B1/B1+
	7	53-58	B1+
	8	59-66	B2
III: Advanced	9	67-72	B2+
	10	73-78	C1
	11	79-84	C1
	12	85-90	C2

Table 3: CLB-GSE alignment compared to CLB-CEFR

Stage III – Benchmark 9

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand main intent and some implied meanings in complex communication between speakers with varying roles and relationships.	Can follow a discussion in which speakers use some idiomatic language.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand when something is being said ironically in a casual conversation.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can infer attitude and mood in discussions by using contextual, grammatical and lexical cues.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise repetition of ideas through substitution, paraphrasing, etc. in complex arguments.	71	B2+ (67-75)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand complex multistep directions and instructions for familiar procedures.	Can extract specific details from poor quality public announcements, e.g., in a station, sports stadium, etc.	69	B2+ (67-75)
III. Getting things done	Understand complex and extended communication intended to influence, persuade or inform significant decisions (such as proposals, suggestions or recommendations for solving problems).	Can recognise that ideas in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture contrast when signalled by discourse markers.	65	B2 (59-66)
		Can recognise the tone and intended audience of a formal presentation.	66	B2 (59-66)
		Can recognise indirect disagreement expressed through modifiers used during a negotiation.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise that ideas in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture are similar when signalled by discourse markers.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can follow a wide range of factual and creative texts and summarise themes and opinions.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand the main points of complex academic/professional presentations.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can distinguish between the main ideas and related ideas in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can evaluate hypothetical proposals in a presentation or lecture.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can evaluate the strength of a speaker's argument in a linguistically complex presentation or discussion.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can evaluate the effectiveness of a selected speaking style in a presentation or lecture to support a point of view.	74	B2+ (67-75)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand complex, extended discussions between several speakers.	Can understand summaries of data or research used to support an extended argument.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can identify personal bias in a presentation or lecture.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can identify key information in linguistically complex conversations at natural speed.	71	B2+ (67-75)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Manage a range of personal and business interactions that involve needs, feelings and attitudes (such as respect and indifference).	Can adjust to the changes of direction, style and emphasis normally found in conversation.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can initiate, maintain and end discourse naturally with effective turn-taking.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can comment tactfully on other people's contributions to a discussion.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can express an attitude, opinion or idea using idiomatic language.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can shift between formal and informal registers as and when required.	72	B2+ (67-75)
	Co-facilitate or contribute to discussions or debates in small formal groups.	Can close a meeting or discussion using appropriate language.	63	B2 (59-66)
		Can politely intervene to prevent someone from dominating a group discussion.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can encourage agreement during group discussions by indicating the areas where people have the same opinion.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can lead a discussion so that the group is able to make a decision.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can politely respond to interruptions during a discussion and return to the main topic.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can politely bring a discussion back to the main point when the participants have gone off topic.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can redirect conversation in a meeting to include all attendees.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can negotiate different cultural perspectives in a discussion.	71	B2+ (67-75)
II. Giving instructions	Give complex instructions for some technical and nontechnical tasks, procedures and processes.	Can make a complicated issue easier to understand by presenting the components of the argument separately.	72	B2+ (67-75)
III. Getting things done	Present formal proposals to address concerns or deal with problems.	Can outline the main points in a disagreement with reasonable precision and explain the positions of the parties involved.	65	B2 (59-66)
		Can, by asking questions, identify areas of common ground and invite each side to highlight possible solutions.	65	B2 (59-66)
		Can summarise the statements made by the two sides, highlighting areas of agreement and obstacles to agreement.	66	B2 (59-66)
		Can speculate about the causes of an issue or problem.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can precisely express the potential consequences of actions or events.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can compare the advantages and disadvantages of possible approaches and solutions to an issue or problem.	70	B2+ (67-75)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done (cont.)	Present formal proposals to address concerns or deal with problems. (cont.)	Can present their ideas with precision and respond to complex lines of argument convincingly.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can present a counter-argument to an opinion offered during a negotiation.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can describe a business proposal in detail.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can negotiate a solution to a dispute (e.g. an undeserved traffic ticket, blame for an accident).	73	B2+ (67-75)
IV. Sharing information	Ask for, give and discuss detailed information and opinions to coordinate teamwork assignments, one-on-one and in business meetings, discussions or debates.	Can help define goals for teamwork and compare options for how to achieve them.	64	B2 (59-66)
		Can describe goals using a range of expressions.	65	B2 (59-66)
		Can give a detailed update on a work-related project.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can describe the results and consequences of a specific action taken by an employee.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can highlight the main issue that needs to be resolved in a complex task and the important aspects that need to be taken into account.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can express varying degrees of certainty about a recommended course of action during a discussion.	68	B2+ (67-75)
	Give demonstrations, briefings, oral reports or position papers on familiar or researched topics.	Can express ideas in a discussion or presentation using an appropriate tone and register.	65	B2 (59-66)
		Can respond to follow-up questions at a presentation.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can link a logical series of ideas leading to a suggested conclusion in a presentation.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can present information related to the business in a formal discussion.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can give a presentation about a product or service offered by a company or institution.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can justify points made during a presentation by referring to information in graphs and charts.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can talk about trends in detail.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can compare and evaluate different ideas using a range of linguistic devices.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can give clear presentations highlighting significant points with relevant supporting detail.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can give well-structured, detailed presentations on a wide range of familiar subjects.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can use a variety of linking words efficiently to mark clearly the relationships between ideas.	71	B2+ (67-75)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand complex written communication (such as editorials, letters to the editor, personal essays and fiction) conveying general opinions and points of view.	Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of a simple discursive essay.	63	B2 (59–66)
		Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of a simple argumentative essay.	66	B2 (59–66)
		Can understand differences and similarities between points of view in extended texts.	67	B2+ (67–75)
		Can identify different styles, genres, and registers in written discourse.	67	B2+ (67–75)
		Can identify the main topic and related ideas in a linguistically complex text.	68	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand the positive and negative connotations of words that have similar meanings.	68	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand complex, detailed correspondence, with occasional support from a dictionary.	70	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand inferred meaning in formal structured text.	70	B2+ (67–75)
		Can distinguish between fact and opinion in complex formal contexts.	71	B2+ (67–75)
		Can identify relevant articles and reports on a range of professional topics.	71	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand inferred meaning in narratives.	73*	B2+ (67–75)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand formal instructions for familiar procedures in complex texts containing advisories, recommendations, policies and regulations.	Can understand the details of long complex instructions in their field, rereading as necessary.	68	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand complex technical information such as operating instructions, specifications for familiar products and services.	68	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand advice given in a linguistically complex text.	69	B2+ (67–75)
III. Getting things done	Obtain and accurately interpret information from complex texts to inform significant decisions.	Can infer meaning from contextual clues in an official document or report.	68	B2+ (67–75)
		Can quickly scan long, complex texts for key information.	69	B2+ (67–75)
		Can extract key details from a complex business report in their field.	69	B2+ (67–75)
		Can understand a complex form for company-offered services (e.g. medical insurance).	71	B2+ (67–75)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Comprehending information	Understand the organization, underlying structure and development of ideas in complex texts.	Can infer what will come next in an unstructured text by using contextual, grammatical and lexical cues.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise common discourse markers that convey emphasis in a linguistically complex text.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can identify key information in a linguistically complex text.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can guess the meaning of an unfamiliar word from context in a linguistically complex text.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can extract key details from a scientific article.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can distinguish between the main idea and related ideas in a linguistically complex academic text.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can follow the development of a central theme to support a specific conclusion in an academic text.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand linguistically complex texts in their field.	72	B2+ (67-75)
	Interpret information contained in complex formatted texts (such as charts, graphs and diagrams).	Can synthesise information from different sources in order to give a written or oral summary.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand details of the use of numerical data in charts and graphs in a linguistically complex academic text.	73	B2+ (67-75)
	Conduct a complex search of online reference sources to research a defined topic that is limited in scope.	Can use a variety of reference materials to check factual information quickly and efficiently.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can use a synopsis to identify where specific information can be located in a long text.	69	B2+ (67-75)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey a range of personal and business messages in semi-formal or formal correspondence with a sense of audience, formality and language appropriate to the occasion, intent and context.	Can write about feelings and the personal significance of experiences in detail.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write clear and precise emails intended to create rapport and put the addressee at ease.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can comment in writing on work-related news and events in some detail.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can express the same idea with a different level of formality appropriate to the audience.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can convey information and ideas on abstract and concrete topics.	70	B2+ (67-75)
II. Reproducing information	Reduce complex information and ideas from multiple sources as functional notes, outlines or summaries for personal use or for defined audiences.	Can synthesise and evaluate familiar information and arguments from a number of sources.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write an effective and informative summary.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can take notes while researching an unfamiliar topic.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can summarise sources and data appropriately.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can summarise relevant data or research in support of an argument.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can make a specific, complex piece of information in their field clearer and more explicit for others by paraphrasing it in simpler language.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a report on an academic subject.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can make a complicated issue easier to understand by presenting the components of the argument separately.	72	B2+ (67-75)
III. Getting things done	Write business or service correspondence for a broad range of purposes (such as making and responding to requests for information, services or products).	Can write detailed minutes of a meeting.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a forceful but polite letter of complaint, including supporting details and a statement of the desired outcome.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a factual comparison of products and services from different companies.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a detailed list of an employee's strengths and weaknesses.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a plan of action detailing a problem, how it will be fixed, and by when.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can seek confirmation of information and ideas on abstract and concrete topics.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can deal with misunderstandings and unexpected problems that arise in online collaborative or transactional exchanges by responding politely and appropriately in order to help resolve the issue.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a detailed report of work-related events.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write work-related materials using persuasive language.	72	B2+ (67-75)

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done (cont.)	Write short reports and memos to convey suggestions, recommendations, requests and updates.	Can respond in writing to other people's arguments in an appropriate style.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can link a logical series of ideas leading to a suggested conclusion in a written report.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a detailed work-related report outlining issues and problems.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can respond in writing to a request for a detailed status update on a project.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a report summarising business plans and strategies.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can summarise findings in a work-related report using appropriate language and style.	69	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a structured report analysing advantages and disadvantages of a situation and recommending action.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a detailed structured report on work-related topics.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a report explaining in detail a work-related problem, the actions taken, and the results of those actions.	71	B2+ (67-75)
	Complete extensive complex forms and documents with pre-set formats.	Can make detailed comments about numerical information in graphs and charts.	66	B2 (59-66)
IV. Sharing information	Write coherent texts (such as essays, reports or narratives) to relate events from the past to describe and compare complex ideas, phenomena or processes, or to express and analyze opinions.	Can write clear, detailed descriptions on a variety of subjects related to their field of interest.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can systematically develop an argument giving the reasons for or against a point of view.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write effective and appropriate paragraphs in a range of genres.	67	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write clear and organised guidelines for the workplace.	68	B2+ (67-75)
		Can summarise opposing arguments in writing, including supporting evidence.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can clarify a concept in a narrative text using adverbial clauses, phrases and modifiers.	70	B2+ (67-75)
		Can demonstrate understanding of structure and conventions of different written genres.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a detailed, reasoned argument for or against a case.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can check and correct spelling, punctuation and grammar mistakes in long written texts.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can structure an essay to incorporate counter-arguments.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can develop an argument with appropriate highlighting of significant points and relevant supporting detail.	73	B2+ (67-75)

Stage III – Benchmark 10

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand complex communication to identify attitudes, emotions, motivations and intentions.	Can follow a work-related discussion between fluent speakers.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise discourse markers that convey turn-taking in a linguistically complex academic discussion.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise the use of emphasis to highlight significant points supporting an argument in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can infer opinions in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand implied meaning in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand stories being told by a fluent speaker using colloquial language.	79	C1 (76-84)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand complex multistep directions and instructions for less-familiar procedures in some urgent or demanding situations.	Can understand detailed medical advice.	72	B2+ (67-75)
III. Getting things done	Understand content, values and assumptions in communication intended to influence or persuade.	Can recognise the use of rhetorical questions to reveal unstated assumptions.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise the use of persuasive language in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can recognise coherence devices and follow complex arguments on unfamiliar topics.	77	C1 (76-84)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand extensive lectures or presentations, complex expository or argumentative exchanges or discussions between several speakers.	Can follow abstract argumentation, for example the balancing of alternatives and the drawing of a conclusion.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise the use of language that expresses doubt in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can follow lines of argument in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can identify a speaker's point of view in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture in their field of specialisation.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can identify logical flaws in a presentation or lecture.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can evaluate the strength of a speaker's source materials used to make a point in a presentation or discussion.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can identify details supporting a point of view in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture in their field of specialisation.	77	C1 (76-84)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Manage an expanding range of personal and business interactions that involve needs, feelings and attitudes (such as perceived hostility, blame, sarcasm or condescension).	Can respond politely and in detail to hostile questions.	71	B2+ (67-75)
		Can rephrase controversial statements into more neutral language.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can participate in linguistically complex discussions about attitudes and opinions.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can use a range of hedging techniques to express doubt in a linguistically complex academic presentation or discussion.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can reformulate what they want to say during a conversation or discussion using linguistically complex language.	80	C1 (76-84)
	Co-facilitate or contribute to discussions or debates in large formal groups.	Can make a verbal summary to confirm their understanding of a linguistically complex discourse.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can effectively chair a debate, managing contributions and reaching a conclusion.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can adjust tone or language to build rapport in situations where there may be an unequal power dynamic.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can contribute to a group discussion using linguistically complex language.	79	C1 (76-84)
II. Giving instructions	Give complex instructions for some technical and nontechnical tasks, procedures and processes in somewhat demanding situations.	Can give detailed technical instructions in their field of specialisation.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can provide clarification of a complex point in a discussion using reformulation and paraphrase.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can carry out complex business transactions with vendors and suppliers.	78	C1 (76-84)
III. Getting things done	Persuade persons in authority to grant approvals or accept/reject proposals.	Can put forward a smoothly flowing and logical structured argument, highlighting significant points.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can present a negotiating proposal in detail.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can justify a point of view using linguistically complex language.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can give a detailed account of a complex subject, ending with a clear conclusion.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can give reasons and explanations for their opinions using linguistically complex language.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can explain the main points of a negotiating position with precision.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can use a wide range of persuasive techniques in presentations and discussions to encourage others to take a course of action.	80	C1 (76-84)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Sharing information	Ask for, give and discuss detailed complex information and opinions to coordinate teamwork assignments, train others, delegate, solve problems, resolve conflicts or make decisions in meetings and business discussions. Participate in a formal debate.	Can evaluate problems, challenges and proposals in a collaborative discussion in order to decide on the way forward.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can organise and manage collaborative group work efficiently.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can contribute to collaborative decision making and problem solving, expressing and co-developing ideas, explaining details and making suggestions for future action.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can use persuasive language to convince others to agree with their recommended course of action during a discussion.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can make a clear strong argument during a formal discussion.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can exchange complex information on a wide range of matters related to their work.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can elicit possible solutions from parties in disagreement in order to help them to reach consensus, formulating open-ended, neutral questions to minimise embarrassment or offence.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can present detailed, evidence-based arguments during work-related meetings.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can give a progress report including key milestones and highlighting risks.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can use persuasive language to suggest that parties in disagreement shift towards a new position.	76	C1 (76-84)
	Give seminar-style presentations to explain complex concepts and ideas on familiar or researched topics.	Can describe a complex process or product development diagram.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can summarise complex diagrams and visual information during a formal presentation when requested by a member of the audience.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can make a linguistically complex business presentation with the help of notes.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can use a range of cohesive devices to structure an academic presentation.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can discuss charts and graphs in an academic text, using linguistically complex language.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can effectively discuss the meaning and implications of research data.	78	C1 (76-84)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand complex written communication (such as editorials, letters to the editor, personal essays and fiction) conveying stated and unstated values and assumptions.	Can get the gist of specialised articles and technical texts outside their field.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand the writer's purpose in a linguistically complex academic text.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand correspondence containing idiomatic or non-standard language.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can infer the author's attitude in a linguistically complex academic text.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can identify similar and contrasting opinions, including inferred meaning, across a range of texts.	76*	C1 (76-84)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand and summarize complex instructional texts about familiar procedures.	Can understand definitions of technical terms presented in a linguistically complex academic text.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can understand a detailed description in a linguistically complex academic text.	77	C1 (76-84)
III. Getting things done	Obtain and accurately interpret information from multiple complex texts to inform significant decisions.	Can identify specific information in a linguistically complex factual text.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can scan a linguistically complex academic text to find specific information.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can distinguish between facts and opinions in linguistically complex written proposals.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can follow abstract argumentation, for example the balancing of alternatives and the drawing of a conclusion.	77	C1 (76-84)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Comprehending information	Understand, summarize and evaluate the development of arguments in complex texts (such as lengthy research papers, problem-solution essays or persuasive articles).	Can recognise organisational patterns within a linguistically complex academic text.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can recognise the writer's point of view in a linguistically complex academic text.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can identify the main line of argument in a linguistically complex academic text.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can follow the sequence of events or arguments in an extended and linguistically complex academic text.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can identify examples that support a particular interpretation of a linguistically complex text.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can evaluate evidence presented in a linguistically complex argumentative text.	80	C1 (76-84)
	Interpret and summarize information and ideas contained in complex formatted texts.	Can extract key details from quantitative data in complex business documents.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can compare and critically evaluate a summary against the original text.	75	B2+ (67-75)
	Conduct a complex search of relevant online reference sources to research a topic.	Can use relevant material in academic textbooks and articles to support or challenge an argument.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can extract information, ideas and opinions from highly specialised sources within their field.	78	C1 (76-84)

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey an expanding range of personal and business messages in semi-formal or formal correspondence with a sense of audience, formality and language appropriate to the occasion, intent and context.	Can write a polite response to an argumentative communication about a difficult work-related issue.	72	B2+ (67-75)
		Can engage in online exchanges, linking their contributions to previous ones in the thread, understanding cultural implications and reacting appropriately.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can edit a text to make the style more neutral or formal.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can modify the language and organisation of written information when moving from one form of delivery to another.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can express themselves fluently in writing, adapting the level of formality to the context.	77	C1 (76-84)
II. Reproducing information	Reduce complex, extensive information and ideas from multiple sources as an accurate outline, summary or abstract, suitable for other people's use.	Can write a detailed summary of work-related information.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can take notes on a linguistically complex presentation or lecture in their field of specialisation.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a clear summary of a complex factual text, maintaining its original tone and message.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can use complex numerical values in an academic text and explain their significance to the reader.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can take full notes on points made during meetings on a wide range of work-related topics.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can summarise information from a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can write an accurate summary of a complex, discursive text.	77	C1 (76-84)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done	Write business or service correspondence for a broad range of purposes (such as giving instructions, or expressing and responding to complaints, claims or adjustments).	Can write a detailed description of a complex process.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can adapt the language and organisation of a project communication to the needs of different audiences.	76	C1 (76-84)
	Write semi-formal reports and proposals.	Can develop a written case to persuade others about the advantages or disadvantages of a course of action.	73	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write essays and reports synthesising information from a number of sources.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can write a review of a product or service using linguistically complex language.	79	C1 (76-84)
	Complete complex forms and documents with pre-set formats.	Can write a letter of application using appropriate conventions and a range of linguistically complex language.	76	C1 (76-84)
IV. Sharing information	Write effective, stylistically complex, and lengthy texts (such as expository or argument essays, symbolic stories, inquiry papers, problem-solution papers, or analytic reports) on previously researched topics.	Can use a range of verb tenses to convey nuances of meaning in an academic text.	74	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a linguistically complex essay in response to a specific question.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can refute a counter-argument in written work.	75	B2+ (67-75)
		Can write a report describing business plans and strategies in detail.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can write effective and appropriate essays in a range of genres.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can support a thesis in an academic text using research findings.	79	C1 (76-84)

Stage III – Benchmark 11

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand propositionally and linguistically complex communication between diverse speakers to resolve conflicts, build consensus and negotiate compromise.	Can understand the intended double meaning of a word used in a joke.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can recognise digressions and asides as an argumentative tactic in a debate or discussion.	80	C1 (76-84)
		Can infer meaning, opinion, attitude, etc. in fast-paced conversations between fluent speakers.	81	C1 (76-84)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand complex multistep directions and instructions for unfamiliar procedures in urgent or demanding situations.	Can understand the details in a linguistically complex audio recording.	82	C1 (76-84)
III. Getting things done	Understand the nuances and subtleties of communication intended to influence or persuade across a broad variety of general interest, academic and technical topics in own field.	Can critically evaluate the effectiveness and appropriateness of a presentation.	77	C1 (76-84)
		Can recognise a speaker's feelings or attitude in linguistically complex speech.	81	C1 (76-84)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand complex, detailed and extensive lectures or presentations.	Can follow presentations on abstract and complex topics outside their field of interest.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can evaluate the strength of a speaker's assumptions in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	80	C1 (76-84)
		Can identify analogies and metaphors used to support a position in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand the details of extended and linguistically complex talks on a range of political, environmental, and social issues.	83	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand implied or unstated meanings in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	84	C1 (76-84)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Manage an expanded range of personal and business interactions to appropriately respond to needs, feelings and attitudes (such as criticism and value judgements).	Can contribute fluently and naturally to a conversation about a complex or abstract topic.	79	C1 (76–84)
		Can participate in a fast-paced conversation with fluent speakers.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can clarify points they are trying to make in an academic discussion, using linguistically complex language.	81	C1 (76–84)
		Can recognise undercurrents in interaction and take appropriate steps to guide the direction of discussion.	83	C1 (76–84)
	Facilitate or chair formal meetings, discussions or debates.	Can act as a mediator in intercultural encounters, contributing to a shared communication culture by managing ambiguity, offering advice and support, and heading off misunderstandings.	76	C1 (76–84)
		Can participate in extended, detailed professional discussions and meetings with confidence.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can ask a series of open questions that build on different contributions in order to stimulate logical reasoning (e.g. hypothesising, inferring, analysing, justifying and predicting).	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can manage the participants in a fast-moving discussion to keep it on course.	81	C1 (76–84)
		Can adjust to the changes of direction, style and emphasis in a linguistically complex discussion.	81	C1 (76–84)
		Can intervene diplomatically in order to redirect discussion, prevent one person dominating or confront disruptive behaviour.	82	C1 (76–84)
		Can summarise group discussions on a wide range of linguistically complex topics.	83	C1 (76–84)
II. Giving instructions	Give complex instructions for technical and non-technical tasks, procedures and processes in many demanding situations.	Can facilitate understanding of a complex issue by highlighting and categorising the main points, presenting them in a logically connected pattern, and reinforcing the message by repeating the key aspects in different ways.	79	C1 (76–84)
		Can talk about complex financial problems in detail.	84	C1 (76–84)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done	Negotiate mutually agreeable solutions to problems.	Can develop the interaction and tactfully help steer it towards a conclusion.	80	C1 (76-84)
		Can make proposals to resolve conflicts in complex negotiations.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can formulate a diplomatic request to each side in a disagreement to determine what is central to their position, and what they may be willing to give up under certain circumstances.	81	C1 (76-84)
IV. Sharing information	Ask for, give and discuss detailed complex information to solve problems, make decisions, supervise, motivate or discipline someone or evaluate performance.	Can frame a discussion to decide on a course of action with a partner or group, reporting on what others have said, summarising, elaborating and weighing up multiple points of view.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can participate in discussions using linguistically complex language to compare, contrast and summarise information.	80	C1 (76-84)
	Give expository or argumentative presentations at symposia or conferences to explain complex concepts on known (through areas of expertise) or researched non-personal, abstract topics.	Can explain subtle distinctions in the presentation of facts and arguments.	80	C1 (76-84)
		Can make a detailed and linguistically complex evidence-based argument in an academic presentation or discussion.	82	C1 (76-84)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand complex communication conveying disagreement or conflict in social and non-social correspondence related to community, academic and business contexts.	Can identify inferred meaning in a linguistically complex text.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand the details of long complex texts in their field without needing to reread.	80	C1 (76-84)
		Can recognise multiple purposes in a linguistically complex academic text.	81	C1 (76-84)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand extensive specialized instructions for unfamiliar, complex procedures.	Can understand complex technical work-related documents in detail.	79	C1 (76-84)
III. Getting things done	Obtain and accurately interpret, analyze and evaluate information from multiple complex texts to inform significant decisions and tasks.	Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of a linguistically complex text describing cause-effect relationships.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can synthesise information from multiple linguistically complex academic texts related to similar content.	82	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand the use of satire in a linguistically complex text.	84	C1 (76-84)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand, summarize and outline the message, position, assumptions, bias, values and motives from fragments of different texts; support conclusions with evidence.	Can understand complex arguments in newspaper articles.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can synthesise information from two or more linguistically complex texts in their field of specialisation.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can compare the presentation of a key concept in different texts by different authors using different styles of writing.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of a linguistically complex argumentative essay.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of a linguistically complex discursive essay.	82	C1 (76-84)
	Analyze, summarize and synthesize information and ideas contained in complex formatted texts.	Can research a topic by reading complex data sets.	76	C1 (76-84)
IV. Comprehending information	Conduct a complex and comprehensive search of multiple online sources of information related to a specialized topic.	Can use a range of linguistically complex reference sources to check factual information.	77	C1 (76-84)

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey an expanded range of personal and business messages in semi-formal or formal correspondence with a sense of audience, formality and language appropriate to the occasion, intent and context.	Can deal effectively with communication problems and cultural issues that arise in an online collaborative or transactional exchange by reformulating, clarifying and providing examples through media (visual, audio, graphic).	79	C1 (76–84)
		Can smoothly switch between a range of writing styles to address specific audiences and topics in a personal way.	82	C1 (76–84)
II. Reproducing information	Reduce and synthesize very complex and extensive information from multiple sources into a variety of formats (such as point-form notes, minutes, outlines, summaries, reports, abstracts or charts).	Can take effective notes while listening to a linguistically complex audio recording.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can select relevant, detailed information and arguments on complex, abstract topics from multiple oral sources (e.g. lectures, podcasts, formal discussions and debates, interviews), provided the delivery is at normal speed.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can write summaries and reviews of professional or literary works.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can write a review of a linguistically complex text, using appropriate conventions.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can collate information from linguistically complex academic texts and summarise them for somebody else.	81	C1 (76–84)
		Can take notes to summarise the key points made during a technical or linguistically complex discussion.	82	C1 (76–84)
		Can edit and add to a linguistically complex text to make it clearer or more concise.	82	C1 (76–84)
		Can synthesise information from multiple linguistically complex academic texts.	82	C1 (76–84)
III. Getting things done	Write business or service correspondence for a broad range of purposes and for external use (such as sales and marketing letters).	Can confidently argue a case in writing, specifying needs and objectives precisely and justifying them as necessary.	81	C1 (76–84)
		Can deal with complex online transactions in a service role (e.g. applications with complicated requirements), adjusting language flexibly to manage discussions and negotiations.	81	C1 (76–84)
	Write formal business reports, requests for proposals and formal proposals.	Can give complex information using appropriate register and conventions.	84	C1 (76–84)
		Can employ high-level vocabulary and structures to enhance impact in written correspondence.	84	C1 (76–84)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done (cont.)	Create forms and other materials with preset formats to collect and record complex information.	Can interpret and present clearly and reliably in writing the salient, relevant points contained in complex diagrams and other visually organised data on complex academic or professional topics.	76	C1 (76-84)
		Can make complex, challenging content more accessible by explaining difficult aspects more explicitly and adding helpful detail.	83	C1 (76-84)
IV. Sharing information	Write effective, stylistically complex texts (such as expository or argument essays, inquiry papers, problem-solution papers or analytic reports) on previously researched topics.	Can use persuasive techniques appropriately in academic writing.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can facilitate understanding of a complex issue by highlighting and categorising the main points, presenting them in a logically connected pattern, and reinforcing the message by repeating the key aspects in different ways.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can use linguistic devices such as fronting to emphasise key information in a sentence.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can precisely select vocabulary for rhetorical purposes.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can reorganise a complex source text in order to focus on the points of most relevance to target audience.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can write a linguistically complex discursive essay.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can signpost a hypothesis in a linguistically complex academic text in their field of specialisation.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can use linguistically complex vocabulary and structures to enhance the impact in academic reports and essays.	82	C1 (76-84)
		Can write a linguistically complex academic essay in an appropriate style and register.	82	C1 (76-84)
		Can adapt their language (e.g. syntax, idiomaticity, jargon) in order to make a complex specialist topic accessible to recipients who are not familiar with it.	82	C1 (76-84)
		Can write a detailed account of an experiment, including theoretical background, findings, and conclusions.	83	C1 (76-84)
		Can write a linguistically complex account of an event, either from experience or from what other people have said.	83*	C1 (76-84)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Stage III – Benchmark 12

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand the nuances and subtleties of propositionally and linguistically complex communication between diverse speakers.	Can recognise a wide range of idiomatic expressions and colloquialisms, appreciating register shifts.	83	C1 (76–84)
		Can understand in detail discussions on abstract and complex topics among speakers with a variety of accents and dialects.	88	C2 (85–90)
		Can follow a linguistically complex lecture or discussion which contains a large amount of specialised terminology or idiomatic language.	90	C2 (85–90)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand and evaluate detailed, extensive oral instructions in a broad range of situations.	Can follow a technically complex process described in an extended and linguistically complex academic presentation.	87	C2 (85–90)
III. Getting things done	Understand the nuances and subtleties of communication intended to influence or persuade across a wide range of contexts, whether familiar or unfamiliar, including academic, workplace and community.	Can understand nuances of meaning in a linguistically complex presentation or lecture.	82	C1 (76–84)
IV. Comprehending information	Critically evaluate complex, detailed and specialized discussions, interviews or formal debates.	Can understand the details of extended and linguistically complex professional and technical presentations.	86	C2 (85–90)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Manage a broad range of personal and business interactions, in both formal and informal situations, to appropriately and effectively negotiate needs, feelings and attitudes (such as recognition, validation, acknowledgement and conflict).	Can confidently take a firm but diplomatic stance over an issue of principle, while showing respect for the viewpoints of others.	87	C2 (85-90)
		Can clarify points they are trying to make in an academic discussion, using linguistically complex language.	88	C2 (85-90)
	Facilitate or chair formal meetings, discussions, symposia or debates for a variety of groups.	Can lead a panel discussion on abstract or academic topics.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can effectively participate in a debate on complex or abstract topics using linguistically complex language.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can take on different roles according to the needs of the participants and requirements of the activity (resource person, mediator, supervisor, etc.) and provide appropriate individualised support.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can effectively lead the development of ideas in a discussion of complex abstract topics, giving direction by targeting questions and encouraging others to elaborate on their reasoning.	87	C2 (85-90)
II. Giving instructions	Give complex instructions on technical and non-technical tasks, procedures and processes in most demanding situations.	Can convey finer shades of meaning precisely by accurately using a wide range of modification devices.	87	C2 (85-90)
III. Getting things done	Negotiate detailed contracts or agreements.	Can summarise the position at the end of a negotiation in detail, outlining their own and other people's positions.	78	C1 (76-84)
		Can propose a range of different options in a complex negotiation.	81	C1 (76-84)
		Can talk about an industry using technical terms and linguistically complex language.	86	C2 (85-90)
	Manage and mediate conflicts or disputes.	Can maintain and develop interaction on an abstract topic by expressing interest, agreement or disagreement.	80*	C1 (76-84)
		Can guide a sensitive discussion effectively, identifying nuances and undercurrents.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can mediate effectively and naturally between members of their own and other communities, taking account of sociocultural and sociolinguistic differences.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can summarise, evaluate and link the various contributions in order to facilitate agreement for a solution or way forward.	87	C2 (85-90)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Sharing information	Ask for, give and discuss detailed complex information to advise, counsel or collaborate on complex projects.	Can give detailed advice on a wide range of subjects using linguistically complex language.	85	C2 (85–90)
		Can communicate in a clear, fluent, well-structured way the sense of what is said on a wide range of general and specialised topics, maintaining appropriate style and register, conveying finer shades of meaning and elaborating on sociocultural implications.	90	C2 (85–90)
		Can facilitate understanding of a complex issue by explaining the relationship of parts to the whole and encourage different ways of approaching it.	90	C2 (85–90)
	Give lecture-style presentations to explain and hypothesize about causal or logical relationships, or to evaluate and critique demands, recommendations or appeals.	Can spontaneously pose a series of questions to encourage people to think about their prior knowledge of an abstract issue and to help them establish a link to what is going to be explained.	80	C1 (76–84)
		Can introduce complex concepts (e.g. scientific notions) by providing extended definitions and explanations that draw on assumed previous knowledge.	86	C2 (85–90)
		Can adapt the language of a very wide range of texts in order to present the main content in a register and degree of sophistication and detail appropriate to the audience concerned.	90	C2 (85–90)
		Can interpret and describe clearly and reliably various forms of empirical data and visually organised information from conceptually complex research concerning academic or professional topics.	90	C2 (85–90)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand complex communication conveying social politeness and cooperation, or their violations, in social and non-social correspondence.	Can understand highly colloquial language in unstructured texts that use complex structures.	87	C2 (85-90)
		Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of different arguments in a linguistically complex text.	88	C2 (85-90)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand complex instructional texts and evaluate and revise them for clarity.	Can critically evaluate the structure, content and style of a text using linguistically complex language.	88	C2 (85-90)
III. Getting things done	Obtain and accurately interpret, summarize, analyze and evaluate information in multiple complex public and semi-public business texts in relation to their purpose and audience.	Can critically evaluate a writer's choice of words to express nuances of meaning in an argumentative text.	87	C2 (85-90)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand the content, organization, language, tone and style of complex, continuous and formatted texts, and evaluate them for validity, appropriateness and relevance.	Can understand complex or extended metaphors in an academic text.	84	C1 (76-84)
		Can understand complex arguments in technical or academic journals.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can understand long and linguistically complex factual and literary texts, appreciating distinctions of style.	87	C2 (85-90)
		Can recognise subtle distinctions of style in linguistically complex academic texts.	87	C2 (85-90)
		Can critically evaluate the writer's choice of words to express nuanced meaning in a linguistically complex text.	90	C2 (85-90)
	Conduct a complex and comprehensive search of relevant online reference sources related to a specialized topic.	Can research a topic by reading linguistically complex academic texts.	79	C1 (76-84)

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey, in a quality, tone and style suitable for publication, a range of communication that synthesizes complex propositions to foster goodwill toward a company, initiative, campaign or political or social entity.	Can create well-structured complex texts with underlying inferred meaning.	85	C2 (85–90)
		Can communicate in a clear, fluent, well-structured way the sense of what is said on a wide range of general and specialised topics, maintaining appropriate style and register, conveying finer shades of meaning and elaborating on sociocultural implications.	90	C2 (85–90)
II. Reproducing information	Reduce and synthesize very complex and extensive information from multiple sources into a variety of formats (such as point-form notes, minutes, outlines, summaries, reports, abstracts or charts).	Can summarise in writing the author's viewpoints, attitudes or opinions in a linguistically complex text.	85	C2 (85–90)
		Can summarise information from different sources, reconstructing arguments and accounts in a coherent presentation of the overall result.	86	C2 (85–90)
		Can interpret and present in writing various forms of empirical data from conceptually complex research on academic or professional topics.	88	C2 (85–90)
	Evaluate, revise and edit summaries and other reduced forms of very complex and extensive information by other writers (such as point-form notes, minutes, outlines, précis, reports, abstracts or charts).	Can redraft a complex source text, improving coherence, cohesion and the flow of an argument, while removing sections unnecessary for its purpose.	87	C2 (85–90)
		Can provide guidance and add precision to the work of a group at the redrafting and editing stages of collaborative work	87	C2 (85–90)
		Can take notes selectively, paraphrasing and abbreviating successfully to capture abstract concepts and relationships between ideas.	87	C2 (85–90)
III. Getting things done	Write highly specialized, complex formal correspondence and documents (such as external correspondence, formal proposals, procedures, training materials or public reports).	Can write about complex subjects, underlining the key issues and in a style appropriate to the intended reader.	85	C2 (85–90)
		Can edit and improve a linguistically complex text.	85	C2 (85–90)
		Can, while continuing to participate in a meeting or seminar, create reliable notes (or minutes) for people who are not present, even when the subject matter is complex and/or unfamiliar.	87	C2 (85–90)
		Can edit and improve a linguistically complex academic text outside their field of study.	90	C2 (85–90)
		Can adapt the language of a very wide range of texts in order to present the main content in a register and degree of sophistication and detail appropriate to the audience concerned.	90	C2 (85–90)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Sharing information	Write effective and stylistically polished texts (such as essays, reports, articles or theses) to inform, convince and persuade others.	Can write the introduction to a thesis or dissertation.	79	C1 (76-84)
		Can base a conclusion on a logically linked series of complex ideas in an academic research paper.	82	C1 (76-84)
		Can write linguistically complex and logically structured reports and articles.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can write up an extended discussion of a hypothesis in a research paper in their field of specialisation.	85	C2 (85-90)
		Can write an academic article for publication in their field.	87	C2 (85-90)
		Can write a research report including detailed analysis and evaluation of own and others' work on the topic of investigation.	89	C2 (85-90)
		Can explain in writing the way facts and arguments are presented in a text, particularly when someone else's position is being reported, drawing attention to the writer's use of understatement, veiled criticism, irony and sarcasm.	90	C2 (85-90)

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